CURRICULUM BOOK

Cash to Company

GRADE 5

Curriculum Book

Money, pricing, and profit

Cost, price, profit. Real numbers. Real customers.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 5 - Curriculum Book

Cost, price, profit. Real numbers. Real customers. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Grade band: *3-5 (upper elementary)* ***Year theme:*** *Money, pricing, and profit* ***Total instructional time (year):*** *~36 weeks · 60–90 minutes per week* ***Anchor:*** *Cash, the program's animated host*

Money in, money out, money left

Cost, price, profit - in real numbers.

Why this year

"*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

- CASH, GRADE 5

Tenth- and eleventh-year-olds are at the sweet spot for entrepreneurship math. They can do the arithmetic confidently (whole numbers and dollar amounts), but they haven't yet hardened the misconception that "if money came in, that's profit." Grade 5 is where Cash to Company plants the

contribution-margin seed without using the term — students learn that profit is what's left after costs, that price is a choice, and that running a small business means making real decisions with real numbers.

The year also surfaces media literacy via persuasive techniques in advertising. Grade 5 is where peer pressure around purchasing crystallizes (toys, snacks, brand clothing). The unit on persuasion is timed to coincide with that developmental moment.

Year-at-a-glance — four units

TRY THIS

Cost it out

Make the thing you want to sell. Write down every supply you used and what each one cost. Add it up. That's your cost per one.

UNIT	WEEKS	TITLE	BIG IDEA	ANCHOR ARTIFACT
1	1–8	Where do business ideas come from?	Ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs you actually see.	A "Skills + Hobbies + Needs" web with two ranked ideas.
2	9–18	The math of one sale	Profit = price − cost. Pricing is a choice with consequences.	A pricing decision with cost, revenue, and profit calculated for 3 sales volumes.
3	19–28	Persuasion in the wild	Ads are designed; spotting how is a skill.	A "two-ad analysis" with at least 5 persuasive techniques labeled.
4	29–36	Run the market	Plans meet reality; reality teaches.	A real or simulated classroom market day with a written debrief.

The Capstone is a Classroom Market Day at the end of Unit 4 — students run small "businesses" (real or simulated) for an audience of younger students, families, or another class.

Big ideas (Stage 1)

WORDS TO KNOW

Cost
Money out - what it takes to make or deliver one unit.

Price
Money in - what the customer pays for one unit.

Profit
Price minus cost. What is left after costs are paid.

Margin
Profit shown as a percentage of price.

Revenue
Total money in across many sales - loud, but not the same as profit.

1. Profit is what's left after costs — not just money that came in.
2. Pricing is a decision with consequences. Higher price often means fewer sales; lower price often means more sales but less per sale. There's usually no "right answer."
3. Ads are designed. Once you can name the techniques (scarcity, social proof, authority, urgency, fear), they lose some of their grip.
4. Plans meet reality. The first try almost always uncovers something you didn't expect. Adjust and try again.

Vocabulary roadmap

MATH MOMENT

Profit per unit

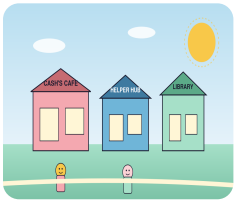
Cost per one: $1.40. Price per one: $4.00. Profit per one is price minus cost. What's left? If you sell 12, what's the total profit?

Unit 1: *skill, hobby, need, idea, customer, brainstorm, pitch.* **Unit 2:** *cost, revenue, profit, price, unit, margin (introduced informally as "what's left").* **Unit 3:** *advertisement, persuasion, scarcity, social proof, authority, urgency, claim, fact, opinion.* **Unit 4:** *market, inventory, sale, debrief, what worked / what flopped / what I'd change.*

Sample Lessons (3 of ~36)

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real prices

Ask: 'Would you pay $5 for this? $4? $3?' Write what they say. The number people actually pay is the only one that counts.

Lesson A — "Brainstorm, Cluster, Vote: Picking a Real Idea"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 1 — Where do business ideas come from?

Objectives

- Generate at least 8 business ideas from a single problem prompt using a brainstorming technique.
- Cluster ideas into 3 categories and vote one as a "real-sounding" pick with a written reason.

Standards alignment

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.
- **CCSS-ELA W.5.1:** Write opinion pieces supporting a point of view with reasons.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2:** Generate and compare multiple possible solutions to a problem.

Materials

- Sticky notes (8 per student).
- A problem prompt projected: "*Kids at our school's after-school program are bored between activities. What could a small business do to help?*"
- Three poster sheets labeled "*Add value*", "*Save time*", "*Make life nicer.*"
- Capstone Journal.

Vocabulary

- **Brainstorm** — generating lots of ideas without judging them yet.
- **Cluster** — grouping similar ideas together to see patterns.
- **Vote** — picking one to move forward, with a reason.

Procedure

1. Engage — Bad brainstorm story (~5 min). Tell a 2-minute story about a kid who had "the one perfect idea" and stopped thinking. Hook: most great ideas come from the seventh, eighth, ninth try. The first three are usually obvious.

2. Brainstorm phase (~10 min). Project the prompt. Each student writes one idea per sticky note, fast, no judgment. Goal: at least 8. Set a timer. No talking during brainstorm.

3. Cluster phase (~10 min). Each student walks to the front and posts their stickies on the three poster sheets — choosing which "category" each idea fits. Read titles aloud as students post.

4. Vote phase (~15 min). Each student picks one idea (their own or someone else's). In the Capstone Journal, write: - *My picked idea:* _____ - *Why I picked it:* (3 reasons.) - *What would have to be true for this to actually work?* (1 sentence.)

5. Close — One sentence share-out (~10 min). Five volunteers share their idea + reason. Class gives one "I notice" each.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Allow native-language stickies, with English summary on the back. Sentence frames for the journal entry.
- **IEP/504:** Reduce target from 8 to 5 ideas. Pre-printed journal template with sections labeled.
- **Advanced learners:** Generate ideas in three "modes" — easy/expensive/silly — and explain how the mode shaped the idea. Push for an "idea you don't think will work but is fun to think about."

Assessment

Formative: Walk during brainstorm; check that students are writing fast and not judging. **Summative:** The picked idea + 3 reasons feeds Unit 1's anchor artifact.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- A student writes 1 idea and freezes. Coach: "What's the silliest idea you could think of? Write that next." Silly ideas unblock real ones.

- The cluster step often surprises students — many will see that their "unique" idea is actually similar to others. That's a feature.

Lesson B — "Cost, Revenue, Profit: A Lemonade Stand on Paper"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 2 — The math of one sale

Objectives

- Calculate cost, revenue, and profit for a hypothetical lemonade stand at three different sales volumes.
- Explain in 2–3 sentences why profit is "what's left" rather than total sales.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7:** Add, subtract, multiply, and divide decimals.
- **CCSS-Math 5.OA.A.1:** Use parentheses, brackets, or braces in numerical expressions. *(Used in profit formula.)*
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 8 Benchmark:** Income from self-employment is not the same as profit.

Materials

- "Lemonade Lab" worksheet (provided).
- Calculator (optional).
- Whiteboard with three columns: COST · REVENUE · PROFIT.

Vocabulary

- **Cost** — what you pay to make something.
- **Revenue** — the total money you take in from sales.
- **Profit** — what's left after you subtract cost from revenue.

Procedure

1. Engage — Two stands, one truth (~7 min). Project two scenarios: Stand A makes $50 in sales but spent $48 on supplies. Stand B makes $30 in sales but spent $5 on supplies. Ask: "Which had a better day?" Pair-share. Most pick A. Reveal: A's profit is $2. B's profit is $25. Surface the principle: total sales is loud; profit is true.

2. Explain — The formula (~5 min). Write: **Profit = Revenue − Cost.** Walk through each word. *Cost is what you paid; revenue is what you took in; profit is the difference.*

3. We do — Worked example (~10 min). A lemonade stand. Cost per cup: $0.30 (lemons, sugar, cup). Price per cup: $1.00. - 10 cups: Revenue = $10. Cost = $3. Profit = $7. - 20 cups: Revenue = $20. Cost = $6. Profit = $14. - 50 cups: Revenue = $50. Cost = $15. Profit = $35.

Coach: notice profit grows proportionally to volume when costs are variable.

4. You do — Worksheet (~20 min). Students compute cost, revenue, and profit for three different scenarios on the worksheet:

- A friendship-bracelet stand. Cost per bracelet: $0.50. Price: $2.00. Compute for 5, 10, and 20 sales.
- A custom-keychain service. Cost per keychain: $1.20. Price: $3.50. Compute for 8, 16, and 30 sales.
- A pet-walking afternoon. Cost per walk: $0.50 (treats + bags). Price per walk: $5.00. Compute for 3, 6, and 12 walks.

5. Close — Why profit isn't sales (~8 min)

Exit ticket: "*In your own words, why isn't 'how much money came in' the same as profit?*" Two sentences.

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Provide a vocabulary card with each term and its formula. Allow calculator without restriction. Pair on the first scenario, independent for the rest.

- **IEP/504:** Pre-printed worksheet with columns labeled. Reduce scenarios from 3 to 2.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a "what's the lowest price you could charge and still make money?" question for each scenario. Introduces breakeven informally.

Assessment

Formative: Worksheet performance; exit ticket clarity. **Summative:** Feeds the Pricing Decision artifact at Unit 2 close.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- A student insists "we got the supplies for free, so cost is zero." Coach: "If you wanted to do this every week, would you keep getting them for free? What would they cost?"
- Calculator vs. mental math: at G5, the financial reasoning is the goal. Allow calculators.

Lesson C — "Spot the Trick: Persuasion Techniques in Real Ads"

Grade band: 3-5 **Time:** 50 minutes **Unit:** 3 — Persuasion in the wild

Objectives

- Identify at least 3 persuasive techniques (scarcity, social proof, authority, urgency, fear) in real or realistic kid-aimed ads.
- Distinguish *fact* from *opinion* in 5 ad statements with a one-line reason.

Standards alignment

- **CCSS-ELA RI.5.6:** Analyze how multiple accounts of the same event reflect similar and different points of view.
- **CCSS-ELA RI.5.8:** Explain how an author uses reasons and evidence to support points.
- **CASEL Responsible Decision-Making:** Ethical responsibility.

Materials

- 6 kid-aimed ads (real or realistic; provided in program assets — toy, snack, gaming app, lunchbox, school-supply, sneaker).
- "Spot the Trick" worksheet.
- Vocabulary cards.

Vocabulary

- **Scarcity** — "only 3 left!" Often used to pressure.
- **Social proof** — "everyone's getting it!"
- **Authority** — "doctors recommend!" or "world's #1!"
- **Urgency** — "today only!"
- **Fear** — "without this, you'll be left behind!"

Procedure

1. Engage — Watch one ad together (~5 min). Project a 30-second commercial (real or scripted). After it plays, ask: "*What did this ad want you to feel? What did it want you to do?*" Pair-share. Two volunteers share.

2. Explain — The five techniques (~10 min). Define each one with a clear example. Hand out vocabulary cards. The principle: ads are designed; once you can name the design, the design loses some of its grip.

3. Practice — Spot the Trick worksheet (~20 min). Students go through the 6 ads and identify which technique(s) each uses. For one ad, they write 1 sentence: "Was this used fairly or to pressure?" Confer.

4. Fact vs. opinion (~10 min). Project 5 statements from the ads: - "Has 30 grams of protein." (fact) - "The smartest kids choose this." (opinion) - "Limited time only — ends Friday." (fact, if true; opinion otherwise) - "Doctors recommend this brand." (could be fact, if backed by evidence) - "If you don't have it, you'll feel left out." (opinion / fear-based)

Students mark each F or O and explain in 1 line.

5. Close — One ad to watch out for (~5 min). Each student writes in the Capstone Journal: "An ad I'm going to look out for this week is __ **because** ____."

Differentiation

- **ELL:** Use ads with strong visuals so the language is supported by images. Cognates: *autoridad, escasez, urgencia.*
- **IEP/504:** Reduce to 4 ads. Provide a checklist version with the technique names already listed.
- **Advanced learners:** Add a 6th technique they hypothesize (humor, nostalgia, identity-belonging) and find an ad using it. Push toward "what makes this ad fair vs. pressuring?"

Assessment

Formative: Worksheet; fact-vs-opinion responses. **Summative:** Feeds the Two-Ad Analysis at Unit 3 close.

Closure

Same as #5.

Teacher notes

- Some students will defend ads they love. Validate the affection; coach toward "what specifically does it do?" Don't demand they hate the ad.
- Connect to Grade 7 — students who do this work at Grade 5 will hit the persuasion vs. manipulation work in Grade 7 with a strong base.

Sample Cash Video Script — "Profit Is What's Left" (Week 9, Unit 2 Launch)

FAMILY TALK

Loud vs. left

Ask: 'What's the difference between revenue and profit?' Then explain it back in your own words, with one example from your idea.

Runtime target: 2:30 **Strand mapping:** MFL + LRCI

[VISUAL: Cash standing next to two shoeboxes, one labeled "Money In," one labeled "Money Out."]

CASH: Quick story. A kid runs a friendship-bracelet stand at a school fair. They sell forty bracelets at three dollars each. They take home a hundred and twenty dollars. They run inside, super excited, and yell "I made a hundred and twenty dollars!"

[VISUAL: A kid running with a fistful of dollars, animated stars around them.]

CASH: Then their grandparent asks the question. "How much did the bracelet supplies cost?"

[VISUAL: An adult animated figure tilts head with a question mark.]

CASH: The kid pauses. Thinks. The bag of cords cost ten dollars. The beads cost fifteen. The little tags cost five. So they spent thirty dollars on supplies.

[VISUAL: Receipts pile up: $10, $15, $5. Sum to $30 highlighted.]

CASH: New question. How much money did they actually make? Not bring in. *Make.*

[VISUAL: The word MAKE in bold; "bring in" crossed out.]

CASH: Hundred twenty dollars in. Thirty dollars out. The kid kept ninety dollars. That ninety dollars has a name. It's called *profit.*

[VISUAL: PROFIT = REVENUE − COST.]

CASH: Here's the big idea. *Profit is what's left.* Total sales — what's called *revenue* — is loud. It feels great. But profit is the truth. It's what you actually keep.

[VISUAL: Side-by-side. Left: "REVENUE: $120" with a loud horn. Right: "PROFIT: $90" with a quiet box label.]

CASH: Most adults running businesses for the first time skip this. They count the money coming in and forget the money going out. They think they're winning. Then they look at their bank at the end of the month and they're not.

[VISUAL: A small bank icon with a sad face.]

CASH: You're going to be smarter than that. The next time you imagine a business, ask three questions, in order. What does it cost? What's the price? What's left?

[VISUAL: Three questions appear, numbered: 1. COST? 2. PRICE? 3. LEFT?]

CASH: Cost. Price. Left. Cost minus price equals — wait, no. Other way. Price minus cost equals what's left. Profit. Try it on a lemonade stand. Try it on a bake sale. Try it on a chore service. Three questions, every time.

[VISUAL: A small magnet with the three questions sticking onto a fridge.]

CASH: Here's your move. Pick one business idea — your own, or one a friend has. Write the three numbers. If you don't know one, take your best guess and label it a guess. Then ask: is the "left" number worth doing the work?

CTA: "*Pick an idea. Three numbers. What's left?*"

[Cash waves. Fade.]

Notes for the Grade 5 teacher

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

- The math is the easy part this year. The mindset shift — that profit is what's left, not what came in — is harder, and matters more. Build that mindset at every chance.
- Persuasion techniques work best with real ads kids actually see. Update the ad set every couple years; old ads feel stale.
- The Capstone Market Day is the year's payoff. Make sure students have at least 3 weeks of build time and access to one practice run before the public market.
- The "what would have to be true" question shows up at Grade 5 for the first time. It's a question students will hear in every grade above this. Plant the seed gently.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Showcase strengthening

Cross-grade bridge note (added to showcase narrative)

Grade 5 is the band anchor for elementary. The reason it lands: it's the last year before the contribution-margin work starts (Grade 7) and the first year where pricing-as-choice and persuasion-as-design are explicit. A student who finishes Grade 5 strong has the muscles for Grade 6's systems work and Grade 7's customer work.

The Cash phrase to plant deep this year: "*Revenue is loud. Profit is true.*" It returns at Grade 7 (contribution margin) and Grade 11 (cash flow). The earlier students hear it, the more it lives in them by Grade 12.

Three multi-class branching scenarios for the showcase

1. **Two stands, two prices.** (See Curriculum Book upgrade pack — Day 1 and Day 2 walkthrough.)
2. **The unfair ad.** Show two real ads side by side: one honest, one borderline. Class debates which one is fair to the customer. Each child writes one sentence: "*This ad is __ because __.*"
3. **The Market Day surprise.** Halfway through Market Day, change one variable: half the class loses a supply, or a "customer" turns out to be a tough negotiator. Children adjust in real time.

"Day 1 Pricing Assumption" — a Grade 7 prefix

Borrow one move from Grade 7 and use it lightly at Grade 5: in Week 1, each student writes a "Day 1 Pricing Assumption" — what would their product cost? what would they charge? — and seals it in an envelope. Open at Market Day debrief. The compounding effect across grades is real: if Grade 5 students do this once, Grade 7's "Day 1 Customer Assumption" feels like an old friend.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Showcase Bridge to Grade 6 (REQUIRED)

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

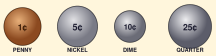
The Grade 5 Showcase is a band anchor for the elementary years. Verify the following before the next print run:

- **Cash V5 phrase confirmed:** "Revenue is loud. Profit is true." — appears in the V5 script and in Lesson 6/8 conferring notes.
- **Bridge paragraph forward:** "Next year, you learn whats *behind* the price — the value chain. Suppliers, producers, sellers, customers." (Add to Showcase document.)
- **Carry-forward artifact:** the Market Day debrief is the entrance ticket to Grade 6 Unit 1.
- **Cash never-says check:** spot-checked for forbidden phrases. Clean.
- **Sensitivity check:** "for a hypothetical 12-year-old" framing in any prompt that touches family money. Clean.

FROM CASH

Money in, money out, money left

Revenue is loud. Cost is sneaky. Profit is what is actually yours. Track all three or you don't really know what's happening.



KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 5 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 5
Spending and saving - budgeting and cost-of-goods.

CEE NS8
Role of price in markets, supply and demand.

CCSS-MATH 5.NBT
Place value, decimals, multi-step money problems.

CCSS-ELA W.5.1
Write opinion pieces - pitch with evidence.

CASEL Self-Management
Goal-setting and planning.

C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5
Explain how profit motivates producers.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

- CASH, GRADE 5

Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep. — Cash

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